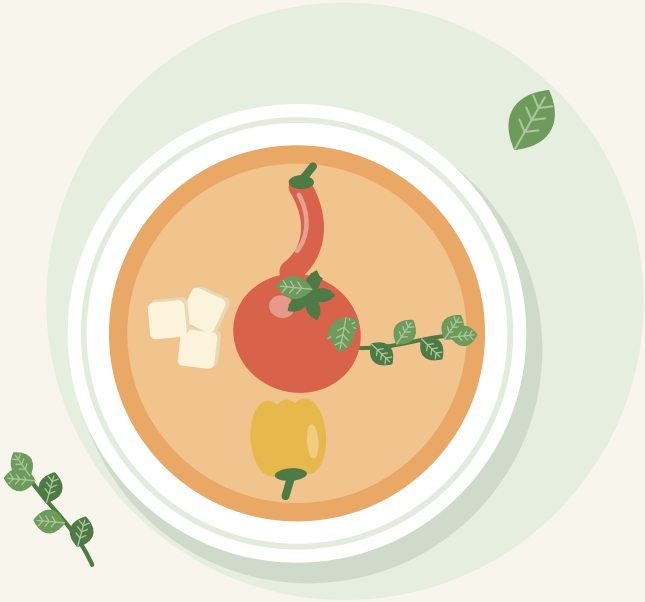
RECIPE 01 · NORTH INDIAN · DINNER

Jain Paneer Capsicum Masala

A rich, tangy tomato gravy with soft paneer and sweet capsicum — no onion, garlic or root vegetables, with asafoetida and dry ginger doing the heavy lifting.

Serves 3 | Prep 10 min | Cook 25 min | Medium

Jain | Gluten-Free | Nut-Free | Vegetarian



Ingredients

for 3 servings

GRAVY

- 2 tbsp ghee
- 1 tsp cumin seeds
- 1/4 tsp asafoetida (gluten-free)
- 4 medium ripe tomatoes, pureed
- 1/2 tsp dry ginger powder
- 1/2 tsp turmeric powder
- 1 tsp Kashmiri chili powder
- 1 1/2 tsp ground coriander
- 2 tbsp melon seeds (magaz), soaked and ground , for creaminess
- 1/2 cup water

PANEER & VEG

- 250 g paneer, cubed
- 1 large green capsicum (bell pepper), diced

FINISH

- 1 tsp kasuri methi (dried fenugreek leaves)
- 1/2 tsp garam masala
- 2 tbsp fresh cream (optional)
- 2 tbsp cilantro, chopped
- salt

Method

1. Heat the ghee in a heavy pan. Add cumin seeds; when they crackle, add the asafoetida and stir for 10 seconds.
2. Pour in the tomato puree with the dry ginger, turmeric, chili powder and coriander. Cook on medium for 8–10 minutes until the oil separates.
3. Stir in the ground melon seeds and water and simmer for 3 minutes until the gravy is thick and glossy.
4. Add the capsicum and cook for 3 minutes so it keeps a little bite.
5. Fold in the paneer, crumble in the kasuri methi, add garam masala and salt, and simmer for 2 minutes.
6. Swirl in the cream if using, scatter cilantro and serve with steamed rice or jowar roti.

DIET SWAPS USED

onion & garlic » asafoetida (hing)
Gives savoury depth without any bulbs.

fresh ginger » dry ginger powder (sonth)
Fresh ginger is a root; dried ginger is accepted in most Jain kitchens.

cashew paste » melon seed paste
Same creaminess, and keeps it nut-free.

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NUTRITION PER SERVING (APPROX.)

Calories	390 kcal
Protein	17 g
Carbs	13 g
Fat	30 g
Fibre	3 g

COOK'S NOTES

- Many Jain households also eat before sunset — this cooks in about 35 minutes.